

Teaching Statement

Qiushi Hua | Department of Economics, University of Florida | huaqiushi@ufl.edu

My goal as a teacher is to have students leave a macroeconomics course able to read the news about interest rates, inflation and the central bank and know what questions to ask. I try to get there by tying every model to data the students can look at themselves, and by being explicit about what a model leaves out.

Experience

I am the instructor of record for Monetary Economics (ECO 4213), an undergraduate course on monetary policy, inflation and central banking. I taught it in Fall 2025 and am teaching it again in Fall 2026. The course is mine end to end. I wrote the syllabus and the schedule of 23 lectures, the lecture materials, four problem sets with full answer keys, the group project and both exams, and I do the grading. The administrative side is mine too, including enrollment, accommodation requests and academic integrity documentation.

Alongside and before that I have assisted ten courses at the University of Florida since Fall 2022. The undergraduate ones were Intermediate Microeconomics (ECO 3101), Intermediate Macroeconomics (ECO 3203), International Macroeconomics (ECO 3713) and Managerial Economics (ECP 3703). The graduate ones were Managerial Economics (ECP 5702), Macroeconomic Analysis (ECO 5207), Applied Game Theory (ECO 6409), Econometric Analysis 2 (ECO 5427) and a special topics course (ECO 6936). At the doctoral level I assisted Microeconomic Theory (ECO 7115). I ran review sessions and office hours, managed the grading workflow for the large sections, and trained incoming assistants on the grading standards and the course systems.

The part I learned most from was assisting the same subject at two levels in the same term. Managerial Economics runs as ECP 3703 for undergraduates and ECP 5702 for graduate students, and the questions are not the same. Undergraduates want to know where a formula comes from. The graduate students, many of whom already work, want to know when it fails and what to do instead. The economics does not change. What changes is which step I slow down on.

Approach

I start from the data. When I prepared Monetary Economics I wrote a full fourteen-chapter lecture deck rather than using the publisher's slides, and for the opening chapters I rebuilt the macroeconomic charts in Python from FRED source data, so students work with series that run up to the present. I bring current data and case studies into lectures for the same reason. A model of the money supply is easier to care about when it is used to read a decision the Federal Reserve made a few weeks earlier.

Most of my students will not become economists, and many have little statistical background. I want them to be able to explain why a result holds, which is harder than stating it, so each result gets said in words before it is written in symbols, along with what would have to change for it to fail.

The assessment design follows from that. Four problem sets carry 20% of the grade and five short in-class exercises carry another 10%. The exercises are not announced in advance, which keeps attendance honest, but each is worth only 2%, so one bad day costs little. The group project is 25% and runs in teams of four or five, with two presentations and a written report. Teammates rate one another at the end, because a group

grade without that is a tax on the diligent.

Teaching across ten courses in micro, macro, econometrics and game theory also changed how I plan a lecture. The courses that gave students the most trouble were the ones where the notation arrived before the question it answered. I now open with the question, and introduce notation only at the point where the argument stops working without it.

Training other teaching assistants on grading standards showed me how much fairness depends on applying the same standard across sections. As an instructor I keep the course rules the same for everyone, including how accommodation requests and academic integrity questions are handled.

Courses I can teach

At the undergraduate level I can teach principles and intermediate macroeconomics, intermediate microeconomics, money and banking or monetary economics, international macroeconomics, and managerial economics. I have either taught or assisted every one of these. I am also prepared to teach applied data analysis and introductory econometrics.

At the graduate level I can teach topics in macroeconomics and monetary policy, master's-level macroeconomic analysis and managerial economics, and applied empirical methods for firm-level panel data, including local projections and work with linked administrative and financial data sets.